

Chapter 19 — Judgement

When not to use any of this

Eighteen chapters of capability. This one is about the four places you should put it down.

The slide to hold in the head

- **Not for a novel derivation.** If the step has never been written down, there is nothing to predict from. You are asking a next-token predictor to be first.
- **Not for anything you cannot verify.** If there is no check you can actually run, stop. If a check exists but costs more than doing the work yourself, that is a different judgement — you have moved work rather than saved it, which is a trade, not a prohibition.
- **Not where the failure would be silent.** A wrong sign that still runs, a plausible coefficient, a citation that resolves to a real paper saying something else.
- **Not with data that cannot leave the building.** Unpublished results, sponsor-confidential geometry, anything under an NDA.
- **Not where the input is untrusted and the output gets acted on.** A poisoned document plus file access is Chapter 6, and none of the four tests above catches it — they all govern what goes *out*, and this one comes *in*.

Five tests. Four are about what you send and what you can check. The **fifth** is about what you let in, and it is the one a confidentiality rule will not cover for you.

Why these five and not a longer list

- **Novel derivation** follows from Chapter 5, not Chapter 1. Prediction over a corpus plainly produces sentences that were never in it — the course spends eighteen chapters on that. The real argument is density: where the data was thin, plausible and true come apart, **and nothing in the system detects which regime it is in**. A step nobody has written down is the thinnest region there is.
- **Cannot verify** follows from Chapter 4. Without a check you cannot tell an improvement from a coincidence, and Chapter 5 says fluent output is not evidence of correctness.
- **Silent failure** follows from the failure gallery, once it is built: every item in it will be there *because something caught it*. The dangerous class is the one with nothing to catch it, and by construction it cannot appear in the gallery.
- **Data that cannot leave** follows from Chapters 12 and 18. You opened those channels deliberately; this is the boundary you set.
- **Untrusted input** follows from Chapter 6, which the architecture makes the gate for everything in Part III. Instructions and data share one channel and there is no complete defence, so the control is what you point it at.

What has not changed

- The claim is yours. The interpretation is yours. The responsibility for correctness is yours.
- None of those is delegable, and no disclosure statement makes them so.
- A tool that drafts faster raises the volume you are accountable for. That is the trade you have actually made this term.

Capstone

One end-to-end task on your own work, using what you configured across the three sessions.

- Your project instruction file from Chapter 10.
- Your eval worksheet from Chapter 4, on a claim you are relying on.
- Your verification habit from Chapter 14, on every source it hands you.
- Your disclosure position from Chapter 18, written down before you need it.

The check, stated before you start: at the end of the hour you can name what you verified, how you verified it, and what you could not. A finished artefact with none of those three is a failed capstone.

If a piece of that stack is missing, that is the honest finding of the day, and it is more useful than a finished artefact.

Round-robin

One thing each person will use this week.

- Not the most impressive thing. The one you will actually do before Friday.
- Say it out loud. Committing in front of five colleagues is the only enforcement mechanism this course has.

What you take away

- The repository — slides, run sheets, the eval worksheet, the failure gallery.
- The one-page reference card.
- A shared instruction file the group owns, not six private ones.

And the habit the whole course was built around: **state the check before you do the work.**

Everything else here has a shelf life. That does not.